

In the Lab FM — Worksheets

Five episodes. Fifteen questions each. Listen twice, think once.

How to use these sheets

Each worksheet follows the same three moments, so after the first episode you already know what to do.

Moment	When	What you do
Before you listen	pen down, 3 min	Two questions to wake up your ideas. Not graded.
The big picture	first listening	Three questions: what the episode is really about.
Details	second listening	Eight questions: names, numbers, order, evidence.
Language in context	second listening	Four questions: what a speaker meant.
Your turn	after listening	Three questions to discuss. Not graded here.

Rules

1. Read the questions of a section **before** that listening starts.
2. First listening: do not write. Understand the conversation, then answer the big picture.
3. Second listening: hunt. You already know what you are hunting for.
4. A short answer in your own words is worth full marks. Perfect grammar is not required here — this sheet measures what you **understood**.
5. Your completed sheet goes to your portfolio (30% of your grade).

Name: Group: Date:

Before you listen

not graded · 3 min

- What holds your refrigerator door closed? Write your guess before you hear the answer.

.....

- Name two things in your home that you trust every day without knowing how they work.

.....

The big picture

first listening · 3 questions

1. What do the two hosts' stories have in common?

(A) Both are about hospital equipment

(B) Both are about invisible forces we trust without thinking

(C) Both are about laws that protect children

(D) Both are about the history of ships

2. What do Ana and Beto disagree about?

(A) Whether magnets can be dangerous

(B) Whether Gilbert was really a doctor

(C) Whether science should follow curiosity or solve urgent problems

(D) Whether old refrigerators were better

3. How does that disagreement end?

(A) Ana convinces Beto completely

(B) Beto proves Ana wrong

(C) They change the subject without answering

(D) Each one admits the other has a point

Details

second listening · 8 questions

4. Why did Ana open her refrigerator door about fifteen times?

.....

5. What had Beto always believed held the door closed?

.....

6. In what year did a law in the United States say refrigerator doors had to open from the inside, and why was that law needed?

.....

7. Who was William Gilbert, and in what year did he publish his book about magnets?

.....

8. Before Gilbert, what two things did people believe moved the compass needle?

.....

9. What did Gilbert build, and what did he do with it?

.....

10. Number these steps 1–3 in the order Beto describes how a speaker makes sound.

___ the coil turns into a magnet for a fraction of a second

___ the signal from your phone runs into a tiny coil of wire

___ a thin sheet is dragged along and shakes the air

11. What example shows how strong a hospital scanner's magnet is?

.....

Language in context

second listening · 4 questions

12. Ana says Gilbert's idea was *completely different*. Different from what, exactly?

.....

13. Why does Ana say the magnetic strip makes the door *perfectly safe*?

.....

14. Beto says: "That is fair. I do that." What is he admitting?

.....

15. Ana says the tool worked and the explanation was "a story". What does she mean?

.....

Your turn

after listening · discuss

- Ana wants scientists working on water and medicine this year. Beto says everything we have come from someone who was only curious. Who do you agree with, and why?
- Name one invisible thing you trust every day. What would happen tomorrow if it stopped working?
- Gilbert's real question was why everybody believed something nobody had tested. What do people around you believe without testing?

E2 — Unit 7 — Congratulations, You Helped Ruin a Small Town 5.1 min

· Score: / 15

Name: Group: Date:

Before you listen

not graded · 3 min

- Think of a place in Mexico that has become very popular with tourists. What has changed there?

.....

- In one sentence: is tourism good or bad for a small town? Write your answer now, and read it again at the end.

.....

The big picture

first listening · 3 questions

1. What is Beto's main argument?

(A) Tourists should never visit small towns

(B) The money is real, but it does not stay with the people who already lived there

(C) Tourism creates no jobs at all

(D) Small towns should build more hotels

2. How does the argument end?

(A) Ana wins and Beto stops travelling

(B) Beto wins and Ana apologises

(C) Neither wins; each concedes a point and they have no clean answer

(D) They discover they agreed all along

3. Which of Ana's points does Beto accept as a fair hit?

(A) That tourism creates one in ten jobs

(B) That her hotel had solar panels

(C) That Venice charges a fee

(D) That young people were already leaving those towns before tourism arrived

Details

second listening · 8 questions

4. According to Ana, how many jobs worldwide are connected to travel and tourism?

.....

5. How many arrivals were counted at borders in a single year?

.....

6. What made Playa Serena famous?

.....

7. Number these events **1–3** in the order Beto tells them.

___ prices went up and Marta's rent tripled

___ the town became well-known because of a photograph

___ tour buses and low-cost flights brought crowds

8. Who is Marta Rivas, and what happened to her business?

.....

9. Why does her son take the five forty bus every morning?

.....

10. What had Ana been telling people about Venice, and what is actually true?

.....

11. What did Barcelona's mayor announce?

.....

Language in context

second listening · 4 questions

12. Beto corrects Ana: he did not say *ruin*, he said *drowning*. What difference does he want to make?

.....

13. Ana says her hotel was *eco-friendly* and gives three reasons. Name two.

.....

14. What question does Beto ask that Ana cannot answer?

.....

15. Beto says he is "not innocent" either. Why?

.....

Your turn

after listening · discuss

- Beto says the real question is "who holds the key to the money". What would that mean for a tourist town in your state?
- Ana repeated something false about Venice for a year. Have you ever repeated something you later discovered was wrong?
- If you owned a hotel in Playa Serena, what one rule would you make, and who would complain about it?

Name: Group: Date:

Before you listen

not graded · 3 min

- Name one job you think a machine could do tomorrow, and one you think it could not.

.....

- What does your ideal job need from a person that a program could not give?

.....

The big picture

first listening · 3 questions

1. What happened to Efren?

(A) He lost his job and left the workshop

(B) A program took over his drawing work, and now he does something different at the same workshop

(C) He refused to use the software and was fired

(D) He wrote the software himself

2. What point do the hosts make about predictions?

(A) Experts are usually right about automation

(B) The people who predict which jobs disappear have a poor record

(C) Nobody has ever predicted a job disappearing

(D) Predictions only matter in medicine

3. How do the two hosts feel at the end?

(A) Both are completely calm

(B) Both are terrified

(C) Ana is calmer; Beto is still worried

(D) Neither one cares any more

Details

second listening · 8 questions

4. How long did the software need to do a job that used to take Efren a whole morning, and how many years had he been doing it?

.....

5. What does Efren do now instead of drawing?

.....

6. What did Efren notice at the bakery in April, and what did he design because of it?

.....

7. What did Geoffrey Hinton say in two thousand sixteen?

.....

8. What actually happened to radiologists?

.....

9. What happened to the number of bank tellers in the United States after cash machines arrived?

.....

10. Why did that happen?

.....

11. Why does Ana think her friend's job is at risk, even though it feels safe?

.....

Language in context

second listening · 4 questions

12. Beto says Efren “could not keep up with it”. Keep up with what?

.....

13. Efren “had to come up with something else”. What does that tell you he did?

.....

14. Efren says: “I look forward to Mondays now, and I never did in eleven years.” What does this tell us about his new work?

.....

15. Beto says Ana’s friend *is likely to* get a new job description one morning. Is he certain or guessing, and how do you know?

.....

Your turn

after listening · discuss

- Which part of your week could nobody copy? Both hosts admit their own list is short.
- Efren’s value came from noticing a door. What do you notice that a program would not?
- If your future job vanished next March, what would you do on the Tuesday?

Name: Group: Date:

Before you listen

not graded · 3 min

- Write down one English word about clothes or style that you have learned in the last two years.

.....

- Where do you think brand new words come from? Guess two ways.

.....

The big picture

first listening · 3 questions

1. What surprises Ana at the beginning?

(A) Her father bought new leggings

(B) Her sixty-eight-year-old father used the word *athleisure*

(C) Her father started going to the gym

(D) Her father spilled her coffee

2. What do the hosts disagree about?

(A) Whether *normcore* will still be used in twenty years(B) Whether *upcycling* helps the planet

(C) Whether Teo's jackets are too expensive

(D) Whether her father follows fashion

3. According to Ana, what is the best way for a word to die?

(A) When people start hating it

(B) When a dictionary removes it

(C) When it wins so completely that nobody needs it any more

(D) When young people stop saying it

Details

second listening · 8 questions

4. What is the oldest printed example of *athleisure* in the dictionary, and what had Ana believed?

.....

5. Where and when did the word *normcore* come from?

.....

6. What does Beto's cousin Teo make, and what does he make it from?

.....

7. How many jackets does Teo sell in a month?

.....

8. Who used the word *upcycling* first, and why was he complaining?

.....

9. Where did the term *fast fashion* come from?

.....

10. How did the fashion industry work before, and how does it work now?

.....

11. How has the dress code changed in the building where Ana used to work?

.....

Language in context

second listening · 4 questions

12. How was the word *athleisure* built? Write the two words it comes from.

.....

13. Beto says *fast fashion* was “not built at all”. How is it different from *athleisure*?

.....

14. Beto says he “upcycled a leg”. What had he actually done?

.....

15. Ana says useless words “hang on the longest”. What is she predicting, and does Beto agree?

.....

Your turn

after listening · discuss

- Which of the four words will still be alive in twenty forty-six? Defend your choice.
- Ana hates *normcore* because of how it sounds. Is there an English word you dislike? Why?
- Invent a word for something that has no name yet. Explain the parts you built it from.

Name: Group: Date:

Before you listen

not graded · 3 min

- What is the task you always postpone? Be honest.

.....

- What is the strangest thing you have done to avoid starting work?

.....

The big picture

first listening · 3 questions

1. What is the hosts' main message about procrastination?

(A) It is a moral failure and lazy people cannot change

(B) It has real causes, and small tricks work better than big plans

(C) Postponing always improves the final result

(D) Only students procrastinate

2. What do they disagree about?

(A) Whether the marshmallow study really happened

(B) Whether the famous conclusion of that study still holds up

(C) How many marshmallows the children were offered

(D) Whether Mischel was a real scientist

3. Who turns out to be right, and how does the other react?

(A) Beto; Ana apologises

(B) Neither; they never resolve it

(C) Ana; Beto says he has told the story with the wrong ending for years, and he hates that

(D) Both were wrong

Details

second listening · 8 questions

4. What did Ana clean with a toothbrush, when, and why is she not proud of it?

.....

5. How long did Beto put off paying his parking ticket, and what did it cost in the end?

.....

6. What did Ana do instead of writing her chapter?

.....

7. In the marshmallow study, what exactly was the child offered?

.....

8. Name two things the children did to stop themselves from eating it.

.....

9. What did the study led by Tyler Watts in two thousand eighteen change?

.....

10. According to Ana, what might a child's waiting really show?

.....

11. What did Beto plan one January, and what actually happened?

.....

Language in context

second listening · 4 questions

12. What trick does Ana use to start working, and why does she call it cheating?

.....

13. What is Beto's strange method, and why does it work?

.....

14. Beto says: "the weekend arrives already full of last weekend". What does he mean?

.....

15. Complete Beto's last line: "I do not on things, Ana. I just giving up until Monday."

.....

Your turn

after listening · discuss

- Ana says big plans "feel wonderful at midnight and impossible at eight in the morning". Do you agree?
- If waiting says more about a child's home than about willpower, what should schools do differently?
- What would your "stupidly small first piece" be, for something you are postponing right now?